PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

April 27, 2026
Community Engagement Session: School Rightsizing

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Portland Public Schools Board of Education Community Engagement Session was held at Roosevelt High School at 6941 N Central St, Portland, OR 97203, and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Board Members Present: Christy Splitt, Patte Sullivan, Michelle DePass, Rashelle Chase-Miller, Virginia La Forte, Stephanie Engelsman, and Student Representative Ritorto.

Staff: Jon Franco - Senior Chief of Operations; Margaret Calvert - Assistant Superintendent; Nichole Watson - Senior Director of Family and Community Engagement; Emily Glasgow - Senior Director - P-K Academics; Richard Smith - Senior Director, Data and Accountability.

Opening

The session started at 6:12 pm.

Welcome + Grounding

Nicole Watson welcomed attendees and provided an overview of the materials passed out. Principal KD Parman welcomed attendees to Roosevelt. Dr. John Franco shared the purpose of the engagements and reaffirmed that there is not already a list of schools identified for closure. Board Members introduced themselves

Historical Context

Jon Franco shared the context for the need to consolidate schools citing enrollment decline, and the need to provide well-resourced schools in a budget deficit.

Learning Lab Rounds

Participants were able to ask questions of subject matter experts: Emily Glasgow for Academics, and Richard Smith and Margaret Calver for Data. Common themes expressed by participants for what a well-resourced school looks like, included small group interventions, social emotional support, arts, P.E., access to libraries, and keeping cohorts together. Participants also wanted to see the financial data on the budget deficit as well as what would be saved by closing schools, support for focus option schools, a desire to make sure that equity was considered in decision making, and comments about the need to increase enrollment efforts. There were also comments made about the need to advocate for more state funding.

Board Remarks

Board Members shared what they heard from and expressed gratitude for the engagement. They also encouraged people to attend an upcoming school funding forum.

Closing and Adjournment

The session ended at 7:32 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Manager
Portland Public Schools